

Monica Cholico

Front-End Software Engineer

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Dear Griselle Astrid Ong,

I'm a front-end engineer at The New York Times, and I'm writing to express my interest in the Software Engineer position on the News Stories team. The surfaces your team owns — Articles, Live Blogs, Newsletters, Visual Formats — are the heart of how readers experience Times journalism. The opportunity to work that close to the newsroom — building the systems that bring our journalism to readers — is genuinely exciting to me.

For the past almost five years, I've been building interactive, content-driven applications at the Times using JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, and modern frameworks like Astro and Svelte. I architect modular, reusable components with a focus on cross-browser compatibility, responsive design, and accessibility — skills that translate directly to the reader-facing and editorial surfaces your team maintains. I work daily with designers, product managers, and editorial partners in an Agile workflow.

My full-stack foundations come from Brokerage Engine, where I built features across React and GraphQL on the front-end and Ruby on Rails on the back-end, working with PostgreSQL and Docker in a SaaS environment. While my day-to-day at the Times has been primarily front-end, I'm eager to reconnect with full-stack work — and the opportunity to work across React, Node.js, GraphQL, and data persistence layers on the Stories team is a strong draw. I'm also open to learning Go, which I see is part of the team's stack.

One area where I think I can contribute meaningfully from day one is in AI-assisted development. I use Cursor and Claude extensively for code generation, review, and iteration, and I've been building an agentic workflow prototype that integrates Slack and Jira — using a multi-step AI pipeline to parse unstructured messages into structured Jira tickets, complete with descriptions, acceptance criteria, and labels. It's a real tool I built to solve a real friction on my current team, and it's helped me develop a practical understanding of how AI can improve engineering workflows.

Outside of work, I've built projects that reflect my connection to content and storytelling. Planeta Mujer (planeta-mujer.org) is an interactive platform I designed and coded from scratch, featuring scroll-driven data visualizations using D3.js, Canvas API, and Scrollama. I'm currently completing NYU's Modern Journalism certificate to deepen my understanding of how journalism works from the editorial side. I care about the mission of this organization, and I'd be excited to contribute to the systems that bring our journalism to readers every day.

Sincerely,

Monica Cholico